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GENERAL INFORMATION FOR YOUR CHARTER

CONTACT WITH YOUR CREW

Now that you've booked your charter with us, we will serve as your liaison between you and your crew, answering any questions or concerns that arise on your end as well as keeping you abreast of any upcoming due dates, etc. Your Captain or Chef will make email or phone contact with you after they receive your preference sheets and just prior to your charter, typically around two weeks prior to your charter start date. During this contact, be sure to establish exact pick-up details for your charter as well as the best contact information for the crew..

CELL PHONE USAGE

Most cell phones will have good cell reception in the BVI and USVI. Therefore, it is suggested that you take your cell phone with you. For your time in the Virgin Islands, or other charter destinations, we'd suggest that you inquire with your stateside cell phone company as to the rates you will be charged while roaming and also inquire about potentially setting up an International Plan during your travels.

PACKING TIPS

The Virgin Islands, Bahamas and other Caribbean destinations are very casual.

T-shirts and shorts are suitable everywhere.

Guests usually spend a majority of their time in a bathing suit.

One sundress for the ladies/girls should take you anywhere.

One collared shirt & walking shorts for the guys/boys should take you anywhere.

If you have interest in having one dinner ashore, there are a few fine dining restaurants in the British Virgin Islands and in other destinations that do require slacks & a collared shirt for the guys.

Bring one item such as a sweatshirt or sweater as the nights can get a bit breezy/chilly (in the 70's).

A shoe or sandal suitable for island hikes plus a shoe or sandal that can get wet is suggested.

The yacht will supply you with bath and beach towels.

Sunscreen, sunglasses and a hat are suggested.

Please do not bring any suntan oils or sunscreens in aerosol form (aerosols can be harmful to varnished surfaces). Lotion or gel type sunscreens are best.

Please try and avoid using hard or larger styles of luggage as there are typically no storage areas on yachts large enough to house these. Soft sided and carry on size luggage is best when possible.

Take any necessary prescription medicines such as antibiotics with you as these can be hard to obtain in the islands.

If you plan on diving during your vacation you should consider purchasing a box of non-drowsy Sudafed which can aid in the clearing of air passages. Please check with your doctor.

If you own your own mask and snorkel we would suggest that you bring those with you for personal fit reasons. We'd also suggest the same for your fins so long as you have room in the luggage you intend to bring. If not, the yacht will have snorkel style fins aboard for your use while snorkeling and/or diving.

The main thing is — pack lightly!

SEASICKNESS CONCERNS

Seasickness is rare. Carefree Yacht Charters™ has had first-hand experience with approximately 1,500 charter guests aboard their own yachts in the Virgin Islands and had very few issues with seasickness.

If you have concerns about seasickness you should follow these suggestions:

Stay topside whenever possible when the boat is underway

Focus on items off the boat (such as an island or the horizon) when the boat is underway

Avoid reading when the boat is underway

Other preventative measures we might suggest:

You can purchase Bromine or Dramamine at your local drug store. Follow directions and be sure and take this medication before you feel any symptoms.

You can purchase seasickness wrist bands at your local drug store. These work off of a pressure point system and we have found them to be highly successful with our past guests in the islands. If these seem to be working for you, leave them on all week, even while swimming, snorkeling or

diving.

You can check into obtaining a patch from your physician (please note that these tend to fall off during swimming, snorkeling & diving).

WETSUITS & RASH GUARDS FOR YOUR CHARTER

Carefree Yacht Charters™ recommends 3 mil wetsuits for your upcoming charter for temperature comfort and sun protection for both snorkeling and diving. From first-hand experience, we have found that ladies thoroughly enjoy having a full wetsuit for comfort and protection. However, please note that most guests that visit the Virgin Islands do not use wetsuits and a rash guard top or rash guard top with a little thickness would also work well.

We have provided time guidelines below:

Charters from November through mid December: “shorties” are okay if you do not tend to get cold easily.

Charters from mid December through mid April: full suits are recommended unless you do not tend to get cold easily, but “shorties” will work as well.

Charters from mid April through October: “shorties” are okay, but full coverage is recommended for protection against increased jellyfish. A “skin” or rash-guard top would also be suitable.

You can find several wetsuit and rash guard top options at **Amazon**.

OTHER QUESTIONS?

Our **charter FAQ's page** may answer many of the other questions you may have regarding a crewed charter in the BVI. Email **lynne@carefreecharters.com** to get immediate assistance regarding any questions you may have.

